

21 / IMPLEMENT

The Founder's Growth Readiness Checklist

21 practical checks to help you strengthen what matters.

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YOUR NEXT STEP STARTS HERE

You don't have to fix everything at once.

But you do need to know what deserves your attention.

Running a business means managing customers, sales, people, messages and decisions - while finding time to market the business. When growth feels slow, the temptation is often to add more. More advertising, more content, more promotions.

What if the next stage of growth requires improving what already exists? A clearer message, a better understanding of customers, a deliberate marketing plan, or a simple system to stop leads disappearing in WhatsApp conversations.

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

01 **REVIEW YOUR AUDIT**
Begin with your two lowest-scoring areas. If you have not completed the audit, choose the areas most relevant to your current challenges.

02 **EXAMINE EACH ACTION**
Tick an action only when you have implemented it and have evidence of completion.

03 **CHOOSE YOUR PRIORITIES**
Do not rush all 21 actions. Focus first on those that matter.

04 **CREATE YOUR 30-DAY PLAN**
Assign ownership, set realistic deadlines, and review what changes.

Progress is not always about adding something new. Sometimes it is about doing important things better.

GROWTH AREA 01

Brand Positioning & Clarity

01

Can people understand what makes your business worth choosing?

Clear positioning makes your business easier to recognise, understand and consider.

01

☐ **Define your business in one clear statement.**

Explain who you serve, the problem you solve and the value you deliver.

DONE WHEN: A customer can understand your offer without extra explanation.

02

☐ **Identify your strongest point of difference.**

Choose a differentiator you can genuinely demonstrate.

DONE WHEN: You can explain why a suitable buyer might choose your business.

03

☐ **Align your important brand touchpoints.**

Check your website, social profiles and sales materials for clear and consistent messaging.

DONE WHEN: Your priority channels communicate a recognisable brand identity.

YOUR QUICK EXERCISE

We help _____ who struggle with _____ by providing _____ so they can _____.

YOUR ACTION NOTES

My biggest positioning gap:

TARGET DATE

GROWTH AREA 02

Customer Understanding 02

Stop assuming you know what customers want.

Listen to real needs, objections and buying motivations before deciding what to say.

☐ 04

Define your primary customer group.

Use real customer insights to identify relevant needs and buying situations.

DONE WHEN: You have a written, evidence-informed customer profile.

☐ 05

Document recurring questions and objections.

Review enquiries, sales records, complaints and feedback.

DONE WHEN: You have documented at least three recurring needs, questions or objections.

☐ 06

Speak directly with your customers.

Ask at least three existing or prospective customers what they value and what nearly stopped them.

DONE WHEN: Insights from three genuine conversations are recorded.

YOUR QUICK EXERCISE

Ask: What nearly stopped you from choosing our business?

YOUR ACTION NOTES

One important thing we learned:

TARGET DATE

GROWTH AREA 03

Visibility & Discoverability 03

Your next customer should not have to work too hard to find you.

You do not need to be everywhere. You need to be accessible where your buyers look.

07

☐ **Review your digital business information.**

Check your website, relevant profiles, directories and contact information.

DONE WHEN: Priority online profiles contain accurate and current details.

08

☐ **Identify your strongest discovery channels.**

Use customer conversations, referrals and analytics to select two or three relevant channels.

DONE WHEN: Your priority channels and why they matter are documented.

09

☐ **Test how customers discover your business.**

Search for your brand and relevant service terms; verify the results. AI answers may vary.

DONE WHEN: You have recorded a basic search review and one finding.

YOUR QUICK EXERCISE

Write three searches a first-time customer might use and test the most relevant channels.

YOUR ACTION NOTES

The channel we need to improve:

TARGET DATE

GROWTH AREA 04

Marketing Effectiveness 04

Busy marketing is not necessarily effective marketing.

Give each activity a clear purpose and connect it to meaningful customer action.

10

☐ **Set one measurable marketing objective.**

Choose an outcome for the next 30 days and a realistic baseline-based target.

DONE WHEN: Your objective states an outcome, measurement and review date.

11

☐ **Review five recent marketing activities.**

Ask whether the content addresses actual buyer needs and communicates value.

DONE WHEN: You have recorded changes to test after reviewing five activities.

12

☐ **Connect marketing to a customer action.**

Make the appropriate next step easy: enquiry, booking, signup or purchase.

DONE WHEN: Your priority activity has a clear next step and measurable response.

YOUR QUICK EXERCISE

For a recent activity: objective? audience? intended action? observed outcome?

YOUR ACTION NOTES

Our primary 30-day marketing objective:

TARGET DATE

GROWTH AREA 05

Sales & Conversion 05

An enquiry is not a sale.

Make it easy for potential buyers to understand, enquire and decide.

☐ 13

Make the next step easy.

Test buttons, forms, booking links, contact channels and offer information.

DONE WHEN: An interested customer can complete the next step without avoidable confusion.

☐ 14

Create an enquiry and follow-up process.

Assign owners, record enquiries, set reasonable follow-ups and respect preferences.

DONE WHEN: You have a working tracker and documented response process.

☐ 15

Review obstacles to purchase.

Inspect recent enquiries that did not become sales; validate patterns where possible.

DONE WHEN: You have selected one recurring obstacle to test and improve.

YOUR QUICK EXERCISE

Go through the entire purchase or booking process as a first-time customer.

YOUR ACTION NOTES

One sales friction point to fix:

TARGET DATE

GROWTH AREA 06

Customer Retention & Experience 06

The relationship should not end when the payment arrives.

Build a meaningful post-purchase experience that supports trust and advocacy.

16

☐ **Establish post-purchase communication.**

Choose suitable check-ins, onboarding, support or service updates.

DONE WHEN: A relevant customer follow-up process is documented.

17

☐ **Introduce customer feedback.**

Use short surveys, check-ins, reviews or structured feedback conversations.

DONE WHEN: A functioning method for collecting and reviewing feedback exists.

18

☐ **Create a suitable retention or referral opportunity.**

Consider renewals, support, relevant reminders, repeat orders or referral requests.

DONE WHEN: You have one suitable approach in place or documented for implementation.

YOUR QUICK EXERCISE

Think about the last five customers. What happened after delivery?

YOUR ACTION NOTES

One customer-experience improvement:

TARGET DATE

GROWTH AREA 07

Growth Measurement & Decision-Making

07

If you do not know what works, you may keep funding what does not.

A small, reliable measurement system is more useful than a complex report nobody reviews.

☐ 19

Choose your most useful business metrics.

Select three to five metrics tied to current priorities.

DONE WHEN: Relevant metrics and their definitions are documented.

☐ 20

Build a performance tracker.

Create a simple spreadsheet or dashboard with baseline figures and owners.

DONE WHEN: Your tracker works and can be updated consistently.

☐ 21

Schedule regular performance reviews.

Compare actual results with objectives and record decisions.

DONE WHEN: The first review is complete or scheduled with a clear agenda.

YOUR QUICK EXERCISE

Choose three monthly numbers and write down the most recent figure for each.

YOUR ACTION NOTES

The number we most need to track:

TARGET DATE

YOUR 30-DAY GROWTH ACTION PLAN

Don't try to do everything at once.

Choose up to three practical improvements connected to the gaps identified in your audit. Assign ownership, test changes and review evidence.

YOUR TWO PRIORITY AREAS

AREA 1

AREA 2

THREE ACTIONS TO TAKE

01

02

03

YOUR FOUR-WEEK SPRINT

Put your priorities into motion.

Use this suggested rhythm to focus the next four weeks of your improvement plan.

YOUR FOUR-WEEK SPRINT

01
WEEK 01 / UNDERSTAND THE PROBLEM
Gather evidence and establish your starting point.

02
WEEK 02 / IMPLEMENT ONE IMPROVEMENT
Make a practical change addressing the main gap.

03
WEEK 03 / TEST AND STRENGTHEN
Observe, collect feedback and adjust.

04
WEEK 04 / REVIEW AND PLAN AHEAD
Compare outcomes with the baseline and plan next steps.

Return to your selected actions each week. Track the change, not just the amount of work completed.

YOUR 30-DAY REVIEW

Measure what changes. Keep what works.

Review what happened. Record a starting point, intended outcome and actual change.

YOUR MEASUREMENT NOTES

OUTCOME I WANT TO IMPROVE

STARTING POINT

30-DAY TARGET

ACTUAL RESULT

WHAT I LEARNED

A SIMPLE EXAMPLE

A service business receives 20 enquiries a month but has no follow-up process. It introduces a tracker, assigns responsibility and starts monitoring response times. It checks how many enquiries received a response, progressed to sales conversations, and became customers. Figures are illustrative, not guaranteed.

YOUR 30-DAY COMMITMENT

Over the next 30 days, I will focus on improving:

Do the right things well. Then measure what changes.

WHAT COMES NEXT

You have taken the first step. Now build on it.

Growth does not always begin with a dramatic transformation. It can begin with a clearer message, a better conversation, or a simple system that closes an overlooked gap.

01 / EXPLORE THE NEXT STEP

The Visibility-to-Revenue Playbook

The expanded guide is in development, with deeper strategy, examples and implementation tools.

02 / EXPLORE THE NEXT STEP

Ready for expert support?

Book a free consultation with DFY to discuss your priorities and practical next steps.

A checklist helps you identify what needs doing. A strategy helps you understand how to do it well.

LET US HELP YOU PLAN YOUR NEXT STEP

Explore our services or book a free consultation.

bygracemarketing.com

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FOUNDER, DONE FOR YOU BY GRACE

Educational self-assessment only. Adapt recommendations to your business; completing these resources does not guarantee sales or revenue growth.